

Practice Range

This page details the requirements and desired flow for the Test Range.

The Test Range is a practice level that can be opened from the frontend as a local server for the player to play around with the mechanics.

It should focus on **key educational elements** rather than being the complete onboarding experience.

Scope

Key Components

- Shooting Range

- Magnet Movement Track

- Armory Chest

- Energy and Hearts Zone

Optional Components

- Movie Room

Features

- Leaving Test Range

- Character Swapping

- Loadout Swapping

- Death Handler

- Pickup Spawners

Flow

- Layout

Scope

Development time: 3 Weeks

Testing time: ?

Team

Code

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Design

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- Audio needs and potential QA process/dedicated QA TBD
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Key Components

The player must be able to access the test range by pressing the “test range” button in the front end. This should start a local instance of the game with the active player as the only player.

Shooting Range

- Allow players to test all available weapons in the game.
- Have targets that allow the player to see the damage done by their actions.
- Have targets at different distances to show gun behavior at different ranges.
- Have a visual indicator - either through an on-screen HUD or a diegetic screen - that displays damage done by the player's latest damage event and damage dealt by the player over the last second. (This data is currently displayed in a debug text PIE.)
- Targets should include idle hero dummies with healthbar HUD that respawn immediately when flatlined.
- Gun wall for Hypers
 - Selection of normal weapons should be done by picking a loadout through the already existing loadout selection screen.
- Several pickup spawners for ammo and sparks should be present with short cooldowns.
- Magnetable objects as well as flux cores should be present for tethering practice.



Optional

- Moving practice targets
- Bots that run around

Magnet Movement Track

- A larger area where player can practice magnet movement.
- Should include vertical movement elements to encourage the player to combine magnet movement with actions such as mantling and sliding.
- Should include a “race track” component, where players can try to get through the track from start to end like an obstacle course.

Armory Chest

- Armory chests should be placed in the range for practice and to ease understanding of their functionality.
- There should be a few chests on separate timers:
 - One ranging from 15-45 seconds for quick opening and refreshing.
 - One ranging from 4-6 minutes to present a more accurate image of chests in the game.
- Chests should show up on the map and compass.

Energy and Hearts Zone

- Area to learn about the objective - hearts, planting zones, and energy gain.
- Should display the team energy widget while in this area with two teams.
- One Heart and two plant zones should be present in this area.
- The full flow of picking up a heart, planting, draining, hacking, should all be represented.
- If we can display videos, we should have the energy videos from the how-to-play present in this area.
- If a player drains an enemy zone fully, the UI should show the indicator that normally means “players left to eliminate” but without any way to eliminate the team as no opponents are present.

Optional Components

Movie Room

- Displays videos from the how-to-play screen.
 - Need to check if Unreal display supports .webv format
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Features

Leaving Test Range

- The players need to be able to leave the range without going through the normal loop of ending the game by winning or being eliminated (neither being possible here.)
- We should add a button to the ESC menu that only appears if opened from the test range level.
 - The button should be clear about its purpose “EXIT TEST RANGE”
- Pressing this button will bring the player back to the “play” page of the frontend.
- The player will not see any of the post match flow when leaving the test range.

Character Swapping

- We should enable players to access the character select screen with a quick key push in this level, to quickly allow them to try a different character without leaving the test range and restarting it.

Loadout Swapping

- Players should be able to access the loadout swapping functionality (normally present in the spawn rooms) anywhere in the test range.

Death Handler

- If the player flatlines themselves they should respawn in the player spawn point immediately.
- Even if the player is out of energy (e.g. due to draining themselves in the energy area) they should not be eliminated but respawn as normal.
- The space underneath the level needs to have a proper killbox that respawns the player and any heart that comes in contact with it. Even if we don't have “bottomless pits” the limited time we have to build this means we cannot ensure clipping through walls won't happen.

Pickup Spawners

- To be able to test out character ultimates and familiarise themselves with the pickups of the game, we should place pickup spawners with short (~5s) cooldowns in the test range.
- Main purpose should be to spawn sparks to allow experimentation with character ultimates and ammo to be able to use guns as much as they like, but shields and energy should also be present in smaller amounts to showcase those pickups.



Flow

1. The player is in the **play** section of the **frontend**.
 2. The player clicks the **test range button**.
 - a. If the player is currently queueing for a match, test range button should be disabled.
 3. The player immediately leaves the frontend and **loads** into a **test range level**.
 4. The player is shown the **character select screen** and is prompted to select a hero and loadout.
 5. **Player spawns** in the player spawn point with selected hero and loadout in the test range with a clear view of where to go to try out options. On-screen prompts show buttons to push to switch hero and loadout.
 6. The player moves around in the range, experimenting with the different sections.
 - a. Sections should re-use HUDs that are also present in the game to the degree we can.
 7. When the player is done they press ESC to open the menu,
 8. A “leave test range” button is present only in this level.
 9. Pressing the button brings them back to the play page of the frontend.
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Layout

